An Axiomatic Derivation of Instantaneous Rolling Forward Rate Dynamics via the Kolmogorov Forward Equation

Sachin Oza

March 2026

Abstract

This paper develops an axiomatic framework for the dynamics of the instantaneous rolling forward rate (IRFR) and, by extension, the term structure of interest rates. Rather than postulating a stochastic process *a priori*, it derives the admissible dynamics from four structural axioms encoding rolling-maturity invariance, equilibrium moment transport, and positivity at zero maturity. Under these restrictions, the IRFR is shown to follow a Pearson-type diffusion with affine drift and quadratic volatility, so that the diffusion structure arises endogenously from the axioms rather than being imposed exogenously.

The framework yields several concrete implications. The equilibrium forward curve is exponential, the zero-maturity equilibrium forward rate equals one half of the asymptotic equilibrium level, and the entire forward curve can be reconstructed from a single observed forward rate together with structural parameters. Solving the associated Kolmogorov Forward Equation further shows that the maturity-indexed equilibrium density is a shifted inverse-gamma law of order three, implying strict positivity and heavy tails. The model also delivers a constant market signal-to-noise ratio and a forward-curve transition structure that is analogous to covariance kernels in classical affine term-structure models. Taken together, these results provide a structural account of IRFR dynamics linking equilibrium behaviour, forward-curve evolution, and probabilistic structure.

Equilibrium terminology. Throughout, we work with the maturity-indexed equilibrium regime. All distributional results are expressed as maturity-indexed equilibrium densities parameterized by $\tau = T - t$, rather than as limits in calendar time.

1 Introduction

A central modelling choice in any term-structure framework is the selection of a rate-like quantity whose dynamics are both analytically tractable and economically meaningful. This paper adopts as its primitive the *instantaneous rolling forward rate* (IRFR).

Consider a forward-starting infinitesimal borrowing–lending contract initiated at time t_0 with zero initial value. At maturity $T - t_0$, the buyer pays an instantaneous interest rate $x_{t_0,T}$

on a notional principal. This value defines the IRFR. Because the contract is continuously marked to market, its value process is, by construction,

$$V(t) = x_{t,T},$$

and over an infinitesimal interval Δt,

$$\Delta V = x_{t+\Delta t,T} - x_{t,T} = \Delta x_{t,T}.$$

As time advances from t to $t + \delta t$ while the maturity date T remains fixed, the remaining maturity decreases from $T - t$ to $T - (t + \delta t)$. Consequently, the IRFR "rolls" from $x_{t,T}$ to $x_{t+\delta t,T}$. This rolling structure is a defining feature of the IRFR and distinguishes it from the classical Heath–Jarrow–Morton (HJM) forward rate, which is indexed by a fixed maturity date rather than remaining maturity.

In continuous time, the IRFR satisfies the fundamental bond-pricing relations

$$\int_{t_0}^{T} x_{t_0,S}\, dS = -\ln P(t_0, T), \qquad \int_{t}^{T} x_{t,S}\, dS = -\ln P(t, T),$$

where $P(t, T)$ denotes the zero-coupon bond price and $T - t$ is the current time-to-maturity.

The objective of this paper is to characterise the class of stochastic processes governing the evolution of $x_{t,T}$ under four economically and probabilistically natural axioms. These axioms impose coherence across maturities and time, encode equilibrium behaviour, and enforce positivity at the short end. Their consequences are as follows:

- The drift and diffusion of the IRFR must be affine in the IRFR, leading to a Pearson-type diffusion with quadratic volatility.
- The equilibrium forward curve has an exponential-decay form.
- The instantaneous short-maturity forward rate equals one-half of the equilibrium regime asymptotic rate at equilibrium.
- The entire forward curve can be reconstructed from a single forward rate plus structural parameters.
- The long-time distribution of the IRFR is a shifted inverse-gamma law, heavy-tailed and strictly positive.

Taken together, these results yield a unified analytical framework linking temporal evolution, cross-sectional maturity structure, and equilibrium regime probabilistic behaviour.

2 Axioms

This section presents the four structural axioms that govern the dynamics of the instantaneous rolling forward rate. Each axiom has both an economic interpretation and a mathematical implication, and together they substantially restrict the class of admissible diffusion processes governing $x_{t,T}$.

Axiom 1 — Stochastic Evolution

At every remaining maturity, the IRFR follows a continuous-state diffusion with density $\varphi(x,t,T)$ satisfying the Kolmogorov Forward Equation (KFE):

$$\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial t} = -\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(\mu(x,t,T)\varphi) + \frac{1}{2}\frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2}\left(\sigma^2(x,t,T)\varphi\right), \qquad T-t>0. \tag{2.0.1}$$

Axiom 2 — Rolling–Maturity Invariance

If the drift or diffusion depended directly on calendar time, then two IRFRs with the same remaining maturity could exhibit different instantaneous dynamics, enabling a trader to roll positions forward and exploit systematic differences.

To prevent this form of arbitrage and to ensure dynamic consistency of rolling contracts, the IRFR with remaining maturity $\tau = T - t$ must satisfy a KFE whose drift and diffusion depend only on (x,τ):

$$\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial t} = -\frac{\partial}{\partial x}\big(\mu(x,\tau)\varphi\big) + \frac{1}{2}\frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2}\big(\sigma^2(x,\tau)\varphi\big), \qquad \tau>0. \tag{2.0.2}$$

This enforces an invariance structure across calendar time: IRFRs with identical remaining maturities must have identical local stochastic behaviour.

Axiom 3 — Equilibrium Moment Transport

There exists an equilibrium maturity curve $x_{e,T-t}$ such that, at equilibrium, the first two moments of the instantaneous rolling forward rate are transported along constant remaining maturity. In particular,

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\,\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = -\frac{\partial}{\partial T}\,\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}]. \tag{2.0.3}$$

and

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\,\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}^2] = -\frac{\partial}{\partial T}\,\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}^2]. \tag{2.0.4}$$

Equivalently, the variance satisfies

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\,\mathrm{Var}(x_{t,T}) = -\frac{\partial}{\partial T}\,\mathrm{Var}(x_{t,T}). \tag{2.0.5}$$

The long-maturity boundary condition is

$$\lim_{T-t\to\infty} x_{e,T-t} = x_\infty.$$

This axiom imposes equilibrium transport of the mean and variance of the forward rate across maturity, rather than full stationarity of all moments.

Axiom 4 — Positivity at Zero Maturity

At zero time-to-maturity, the IRFR satisfies $x_{t,t} > 0$ almost surely. To ensure that the boundary at zero is inaccessible, the diffusion coefficient must vanish as the short-maturity IRFR approaches zero:

$$\sigma(x,t,t) \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{as} \quad x_{t,t} \to 0.$$

3 Structural Framework

This section derives the structural implications of the axioms for the dynamics of the instantaneous rolling forward rate. Beginning from the Kolmogorov Forward Equation, we derive affine forms for the drift and diffusion of the IRFR and identify the associated equilibrium relation between the coefficients. The deterministic evolution of the expectation, the variance structure, and several key identities follow naturally.

3.0 KFE Representation and Notational Setup

The Kolmogorov Forward Equation governing the evolution of the IRFR is

$$\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial t} = -\frac{\partial}{\partial x}[\mu(x,t,T)\varphi] + \frac{1}{2}\frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2}\left[\sigma^2(x,t,T)\varphi\right]. \tag{3.0.1}$$

Define the drift–diffusion pair

$$f(x,t,T) = -\mu(x,t,T), \qquad g^2(x,t,T) = \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^2(x,t,T), \tag{3.0.2–3.0.3}$$

so that (3.0.1) becomes

$$\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial t} = \frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2}\left[g^2(x,t,T)\varphi\right] + \frac{\partial}{\partial x}[f(x,t,T)\varphi]. \tag{3.0.4}$$

3.1 Affine Forms of Drift and Diffusion

Statement 3.1 (Affine Forms of Drift and Diffusion)**.** Assume Axiom 2 (rolling–maturity invariance), so that the drift and diffusion depend on time only through the remaining maturity $\tau := T - t$:

$$f(x,t,T) = F(x,\tau), \qquad g(x,t,T) = G(x,\tau).$$

Assume in addition the following affine-closure hypothesis: for each fixed τ, the diffusion has state-independent slope,

$$\partial_{xx} G(x,\tau) = 0,$$

and the net probability flux is affine in the state variable, i.e. there exist functions $A(\tau)$ and $B(\tau)$ such that

$$\partial_x\big(G(x,\tau)^2\big) + F(x,\tau) = A(\tau)x + B(\tau).$$

Then both the diffusion and drift are affine in the IRFR state x:

$$g(x,t,T) = a(\tau)x + b(\tau), \qquad f(x,t,T) = a_1(\tau)x + b_1(\tau), \qquad \tau = T - t. \tag{3.1.1}$$

Derivation. Expanding the KFE (3.0.4) gives

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial t} &= g^2\varphi_{xx} + \big(2(g^2)_x + f\big)\varphi_x + \big((g^2)_{xx} + f_x\big)\varphi \\ &= g^2\varphi_{xx} + \big(4gg_x + f\big)\varphi_x + \big((g^2)_{xx} + f_x\big)\varphi.\end{aligned} \tag{3.1.2}$$

Under Axiom 2 we may write $f(x,t,T) = F(x,\tau)$ and $g(x,t,T) = G(x,\tau)$, where $\tau = T - t$. The additional affine-closure hypothesis now implies

$$\partial_{xx} G(x,\tau) = 0,$$

hence for each fixed τ,

$$G(x,\tau) = a(\tau)x + b(\tau).$$

Substituting this into the affine flux identity

$$\partial_x\big(G(x,\tau)^2\big) + F(x,\tau) = A(\tau)x + B(\tau)$$

yields

$$F(x,\tau) = A(\tau)x + B(\tau) - \partial_x\big(G(x,\tau)^2\big).$$

Since $G(x,\tau) = a(\tau)x + b(\tau)$, we have

$$\partial_x\big(G(x,\tau)^2\big) = 2a(\tau)\big(a(\tau)x + b(\tau)\big),$$

which is affine in x. Therefore $F(x,\tau)$ is affine in x as well:

$$F(x,\tau) = a_1(\tau)x + b_1(\tau).$$

Returning to the original notation,

$$g(x,t,T) = a(T-t)x + b(T-t), \qquad f(x,t,T) = a_1(T-t)x + b_1(T-t).$$

This proves Statement 3.1.

3.2 Equilibrium Relation of Drift and Diffusion

Statement 3.2 (Equilibrium Relation of Drift and Diffusion)**.** Let $\tau := T - t$. Suppose the drift and diffusion are affine in the IRFR state:

$$f(x,t,T) = a_1(\tau)x + b_1(\tau), \qquad g(x,t,T) = a(\tau)x + b(\tau).$$

Assume further that the equilibrium mean depends only on remaining maturity,

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = x_{e,\tau},$$

and that the affine intercepts satisfy the proportionality condition

$$b(\tau) = \frac{a(\tau)}{a_1(\tau)}\, b_1(\tau), \qquad a_1(\tau) \neq 0.$$

Then the drift and diffusion satisfy

$$f(x,t,T) = a_1(\tau)\big(x - x_{e,\tau}\big) + x'_{e,\tau}, \tag{3.2.1a}$$

$$g(x,t,T) = a(\tau)\big(x - x_{e,\tau}\big) + \frac{a(\tau)}{a_1(\tau)}\, x'_{e,\tau}. \tag{3.2.1b}$$

3.3 Deterministic Evolution of the IRFR Expectation

Statement 3.3 (Expected forward-curve dynamics)**.** For fixed maturity T, suppose the expected forward rate evolves according to

$$\frac{\partial \mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}]}{\partial t} = -a_1\big(\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] - x_{e,T-t}\big) + \frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial t},$$

where $a_1 > 0$ is constant. Then

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = x_{e,T-t} + (x_{t_0,T} - x_{e,T-t_0})\, e^{-a_1(t-t_0)}. \tag{3.3.1}$$

Derivation is given in Appendix A.3.

3.4 Drift Constant Equals Stochastic Constant

Statement 3.4 (Drift Constant Equals Stochastic Constant)**.** The affine drift constant equals the stochastic constant:

$$a_1 = a^2. \tag{3.4.1}$$

Reasoning. The identity $a_1 = a^2$ is a structural equilibrium restriction. If $a_1 \neq a^2$, the equilibrium second-moment evolution contains a residual term that can be eliminated only in the degenerate case of a globally linear equilibrium curve, which is incompatible with Axioms 3–4. Hence the only admissible non-degenerate equilibrium is

$$a_1 = a^2.$$

A full derivation is given in Appendix A.4.

Interpretively, this is a drift–diffusion relationship: it ties the drift loading directly to the squared diffusion loading, so that the transport speed of the mean and the variance-production scale are no longer independent structural degrees of freedom.

3.5 Interim Drift and Diffusion Forms

Statement 3.5 (Interim Drift and Diffusion)**.** If one adopts the baseline exponential equilibrium specification

$$x_{e,T-t} = x_\infty + Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)},$$

then consistency of (3.2.1a)–(3.2.1b) implies the interim representations

$$f(x,t,T) = a^2 x_{t,T} - a^2 x_\infty - (\lambda^2 + a^2) A\, e^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}, \tag{3.5.1a}$$

$$g(x,t,T) = a x_{t,T} - a x_\infty - \left(a + \frac{\lambda^2}{a}\right) A\, e^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}. \tag{3.5.1b}$$

This is a conditional consistency result. The exponential equilibrium curve is imposed as a baseline specification, and (3.5.1a)– (3.5.1b) are the corresponding drift and diffusion forms required by that choice.

3.6 Instantaneous Variance

Statement 3.6 (Instantaneous Variance)**.** Under the baseline exponential equilibrium specification used in Statement 3.5, the instantaneous variance evolves according to

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T}) = 2\left(a\,D(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a}Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}\right)^2, \tag{3.6.1}$$

where

$$D(t,T) = \left(x_{t_0,T} - x_\infty - Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t_0)}\right)e^{-a^2(t-t_0)}. \tag{3.6.2}$$

This is the variance evolution implied by the interim forms (3.5.1a)–(3.5.1b) under that baseline specification. A full derivation is given in Appendix A.6.

3.7 Market Signal–to–Noise Ratio

Statement 3.7 (Market Signal–to–Noise Ratio)**.** Define the Market Signal–to–Noise Ratio (MSNR) as the ratio of expected instantaneous return to the square root of instantaneous variance. Under this definition, the model-implied MSNR is

$$\mathrm{MSNR} = \frac{a}{\sqrt{2}}. \tag{3.7.1}$$

In particular, the MSNR is constant: it is independent of calendar time t, maturity T, and the state $x_{t,T}$. This does not require imposing the baseline specification $\lambda^2 = a^2$. A derivation is given in Appendix A.7.

4 Kolmogorov Forward Equation Solution

This section solves the Kolmogorov Forward Equation for the identified baseline model. In what follows, we impose

$$a_1 = a^2, \qquad \lambda^2 = a^2,$$

as the baseline specification and study the implied equilibrium behaviour of the IRFR density.

Interpretively, the restriction $\lambda^2 = a^2$ is a temporal–maturity relationship: it identifies the decay scale in maturity with the same structural decay scale that governs time evolution in the model.

A convenient shifted coordinate removes the deterministic equilibrium component and isolates the residual stochastic part of the dynamics. In those coordinates, the KFE admits a closed-form equilibrium regime given by a shifted inverse-gamma distribution of order 3.

Throughout, we work with the maturity-indexed equilibrium regime, parameterised by

$$\tau := T - t \geq 0.$$

Accordingly, distributional results are stated as maturity-indexed equilibrium densities, while the limit $\tau \to \infty$ will be referred to as the *long-maturity limit*.

4.1 Maturity-Indexed Equilibrium Density

Under the baseline specification $\lambda^2 = a^2$, define the shifted variable

$$\widetilde{x} = x_{t,T} - x_\infty \left(1 - e^{-a^2(T-t)}\right).$$

This transformation removes the deterministic equilibrium component and centres the KFE on the residual stochastic part.

In the shifted coordinate, the forward equation becomes

$$\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial t} = a^2 \widetilde{x}^2 \frac{\partial^2 \varphi}{\partial \widetilde{x}^2} + 5a^2 \widetilde{x} \frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial \widetilde{x}} + 3a^2 \varphi - a^2 x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)} \frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial \widetilde{x}}. \tag{4.1.1}$$

The Frobenius expansion in Appendix B.1 yields the equilibrium density

$$\varphi(\widetilde{x}, t, T) = \frac{x_\infty^3 e^{-3a^2(T-t)}}{\Gamma(3)\, \widetilde{x}^4} \exp\left(-\frac{x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)}}{\widetilde{x}}\right). \tag{4.1.2}$$

This is a shifted inverse-gamma law with shape parameter 3. Its support is strictly positive, and its heavy right tail reflects the multiplicative structure of the underlying diffusion. The scale is set by x_∞, while the factor $e^{-a^2(T-t)}$ controls the maturity-dependent approach to equilibrium.

4.2 Boundary Behaviour

We now classify the behaviour of the process near the lower boundary $x = 0$. For the diffusion associated with the IRFR, the scale density is

$$s'(x) = \exp\left(-\int^x \frac{2f(y,t,T)}{g^2(y,t,T)}\, dy\right) \sim x^{-2}, \qquad x \to 0^+, \tag{4.2.1}$$

and the corresponding speed density is

$$m(x) = \frac{1}{g^2(x,t,T)\, s'(x)} \sim x, \qquad x \to 0^+. \tag{4.2.2}$$

Hence

$$\int_{0^+} s'(x)\, dx = \infty, \qquad \int_{0^+} m(x)\, dx < \infty.$$

By the standard Feller boundary classification, the origin is therefore an *entrance boundary*. Equivalently,

$$\boxed{x = 0 \text{ is inaccessible from the interior and cannot be reached in finite time.}} \tag{4.2.3}$$

This is fully consistent with Axiom 4 and confirms that the model preserves positivity of the instantaneous short-maturity IRFR.

5 Integrated Baseline Specification

This section consolidates the structural results established in Section 3 and Appendix A. In particular, we now work under the two baseline identifications

$$a_1 = a^2, \qquad \lambda^2 = a^2.$$

The purpose of the present section is not to re-derive those identities, but to integrate them into a single coherent specification for the equilibrium curve, the drift and diffusion coefficients, the Kolmogorov Forward Equation, and the forward-curve representation.

We proceed in six steps. First, we determine the equilibrium amplitude A from the boundary condition. Second, we obtain the fully identified equilibrium curve. Third, we simplify the drift and diffusion coefficients. Fourth, we write the associated Kolmogorov Forward Equation. Fifth, we derive the simplified forward curve representation. Sixth, we state the implied expectation and variance dynamics.

5.1 Boundary Condition and Determination of the Amplitude A

From Statement 3.5, the interim diffusion is

$$g(x,t,T) = ax_{t,T} - ax_\infty - \left(a + \frac{\lambda^2}{a}\right) Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}.$$

Under the baseline specification $\lambda^2 = a^2$, this becomes

$$g(x,t,T) = ax_{t,T} - ax_\infty - 2aAe^{-a^2(T-t)}.$$

Axiom 4 requires that the diffusion vanish at the short-maturity boundary:

$$g(x_{\min}, t, t) = 0.$$

At the boundary $x_{t,t} = x_{\min} = 0$, and at $T = t$ one has $e^{-a^2(T-t)} = 1$. Hence

$$0 = -ax_\infty - 2aA.$$

Since $a \neq 0$, it follows that

$$A = -\frac{x_\infty}{2}. \tag{5.1.1}$$

Thus the equilibrium amplitude is determined by the boundary condition.

5.2 Fully Identified Equilibrium Curve

Under the baseline specification $\lambda^2 = a^2$, substituting $A = -x_\infty/2$ into the equilibrium form

$$x_{e,T-t} = x_\infty + Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}$$

gives

$$x_{e,T-t} = x_\infty \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}e^{-a^2(T-t)}\right). \tag{5.2.1}$$

In particular,

$$x_{e,0} = \frac{x_\infty}{2}.$$

Thus, at equilibrium, the short end of the curve lies exactly halfway between the lower boundary 0 and the long-maturity asymptote x_∞.

5.3 Updated Drift and Diffusion

Differentiate (5.2.1) with respect to T:

$$\frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial T} = \frac{1}{2} x_\infty a^2 e^{-a^2(T-t)}.$$

Now, under the baseline specification $\lambda^2 = a^2$, substitute $A = -x_\infty/2$ into the interim forms (3.5.1a)–(3.5.1b). This yields

$$g(x,t,T) = ax - ax_\infty\Big(1 - e^{-a^2(T-t)}\Big), \tag{5.3.1a}$$

$$f(x,t,T) = a^2 x - a^2 x_\infty\Big(1 - e^{-a^2(T-t)}\Big). \tag{5.3.1b}$$

Both coefficients therefore revert toward the same identified equilibrium level, with diffusion loading a and drift loading a^2.

5.4 Updated Kolmogorov Forward Equation

Substituting (5.3.1a) and (5.3.1b) into the Kolmogorov Forward Equation gives

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial t} = \frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2}&\left(\left[ax_{t,T} - ax_\infty\Big(1 - e^{-a^2(T-t)}\Big)\right]^2 \varphi\right)\\ &+ \frac{\partial}{\partial x}\left(\left[a^2 x_{t,T} - a^2 x_\infty\Big(1 - e^{-a^2(T-t)}\Big)\right]\varphi\right).\end{aligned} \tag{5.4.1}$$

This is the fully identified forward equation under the baseline equilibrium specification.

5.5 Simplified Forward-Curve Representation

Using the baseline exponential equilibrium curve together with the baseline forward-curve representation, we obtain

$$x_{t,T} = x_\infty + Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)} + \big(x_{t,t} - x_\infty - A\big)e^{-a^2(T-t)}.$$

Substituting $\lambda^2 = a^2$ and $A = -x_\infty/2$ gives

$$\begin{aligned}x_{t,T} &= x_\infty - \frac{x_\infty}{2}e^{-a^2(T-t)} + \left(x_{t,t} - x_\infty + \frac{x_\infty}{2}\right)e^{-a^2(T-t)}\\ &= x_\infty + (x_{t,t} - x_\infty)e^{-a^2(T-t)}.\end{aligned} \tag{5.5.1}$$

Thus the entire forward curve is determined by the short-maturity value $x_{t,t}$, the equilibrium regime level x_∞, and the common decay rate a^2.

5.6 Expectation and Variance under the Identified Baseline

Under the baseline forward-curve form (5.5.1), the expectation is given by Appendix B.3; see (B.3.1). Explicitly,

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = x_{t_0,t_0} e^{-a^2(T+t-2t_0)} + x_\infty - x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t_0)}. \tag{5.6.1}$$

For the variance, it is safest to retain the direct identified specialisation of Statement 3.6. Using $\lambda^2 = a^2$ and $A = -x_\infty/2$ in (3.6.1)–(3.6.2) gives

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T}) = 2a^2 \left(D(t,T) + \frac{x_\infty}{2} e^{-a^2(T-t)} \right)^2, \tag{5.6.2}$$

where

$$D(t,T) = \left(x_{t_0,T} - x_\infty + \frac{x_\infty}{2} e^{-a^2(T-t_0)} \right) e^{-a^2(t-t_0)}. \tag{5.6.3}$$

Thus the expectation and instantaneous variance both inherit the same identified decay scale a^2, while the cross-sectional shape remains parametrised by the maturity gap $T - t$.

6 Economic Interpretation

This section interprets the structural and probabilistic results obtained in Sections 3–4. Each parameter of the IRFR diffusion plays a distinct role in shaping both the cross-sectional structure of the forward curve and its temporal evolution.

6.1 Mean-Reversion Dynamics

The drift and diffusion coefficients in their updated form (5.3.1b)–(5.3.1a) may be rewritten as

$$f(x,t,T) = a^2(x - x_\infty) + a^2 x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)}, \tag{6.1.1}$$

$$g(x,t,T) = a(x - x_\infty) + a\, x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)}. \tag{6.1.2}$$

Thus, a sets the diffusion loading, while a^2 governs the corresponding drift reversion scale.

6.2 Equilibrium Regime Level and Equilibrium Structure

The equilibrium curve derived in (5.2.1) is

$$x_{e,T-t} = x_\infty - \frac{x_\infty}{2}\, e^{-a^2(T-t)}, \tag{6.2.1}$$

which displays exponential decay from the short end toward the equilibrium regime asymptote. At zero maturity, equilibrium requires

$$x_{e,0} = \frac{x_\infty}{2},$$

This expresses the structural link between the short and long ends of the curve.

6.3 Forward-Curve Dynamics

Under the baseline specification, the expected forward curve evolves according to

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = x_{t_0,t_0} e^{-a^2(T+t-2t_0)} + x_\infty - x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t_0)}. \tag{6.3.1}$$

as shown in Appendix B.3; see (B.3.1). This expression shows that the mean forward curve is pinned down by the initial short-maturity condition x_{t_0,t_0}, the equilibrium regime level x_∞, and the common decay rate a^2. For fixed T, the first term decays with calendar time, while the second and third terms govern convergence toward the equilibrium regime level.

Covariance-style structure and equilibrium. Introducing shifted variables $T' = T - t_0$ and $t' = t - t_0$, so that $\tau = T' - t'$, makes the forward-curve dynamics separate into elapsed-time decay and maturity loading through exponential factors. In this form, the transition structure is reminiscent of the covariance kernels in classical affine term-structure models such as Vasicek and CIR: t' governs temporal propagation, while τ governs maturity dependence.

6.4 Distributional Implications

The equilibrium regime density from Section 4.1, equation (4.1.2), is the shifted inverse-gamma law

$$\varphi(\widetilde{x}, t, T) = \frac{x_\infty^3 e^{-3a^2(T-t)}}{\Gamma(3)\,\widetilde{x}^4} \exp\left(-\frac{x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)}}{\widetilde{x}}\right), \tag{6.4.1}$$

which is strictly positive and heavy-tailed. This is consistent with the empirical observation that interest rates can occasionally exhibit large moves.

6.5 Boundary Behaviour

As shown in Section 4.2, the origin is an entrance boundary. The IRFR therefore cannot reach zero in finite time from the interior.

7 Applications

The structural and probabilistic characterisation of the IRFR provides a tractable platform for simulation, estimation, curve construction, risk analysis, and pricing of interest-rate–dependent instruments. This section outlines several practical uses of the model.

7.1 Simulating IRFR Paths

Using the updated drift and diffusion (5.3.1b)–(5.3.1a), the IRFR under the physical measure satisfies the stochastic differential equation

$$dx_{t,T} = -f(x,t,T)\,dt + \sqrt{2}g(x,t,T)\,dW_t.$$

Given the explicit forms of f and g, one may simulate sample paths of forward rates using Euler–Maruyama or higher-order schemes. The affine structure supports stable numerical implementation, while the boundary properties established in Section 4.2 preserve positivity.

7.2 Yield Curve Construction

Under the baseline specification, the forward curve can be constructed from the short rate $x_{t,t}$ using the representation

$$x_{t,T} = (x_{t,t} - x_\infty)e^{-a^2(T-t)} + x_\infty.$$

This exponential form fits naturally into continuous-time curve building and provides a parsimonious two-parameter representation of the term structure at any given time.

7.3 Risk Management and Stress Testing

Because the maturity-indexed equilibrium density is heavy-tailed and strictly positive, stress scenarios may incorporate large, sudden rate moves drawn from the shifted inverse-gamma law. Perturbations in the structural parameters (a, x_∞) then provide a coherent way to stress-test mean reversion and equilibrium regime rate assumptions.

7.4 Pricing Interest-Rate–Dependent Claims

Under a risk-neutral measure, the drift adjusts to incorporate market prices of risk, while the diffusion remains affine. The positivity of $x_{t,T}$ renders the model suitable for pricing caps, floors, and swaptions, and the exponential structure of the forward curve gives closed-form or semi-closed-form solutions for many related derivatives.

Appendix A Technical Derivations for Section 3

This appendix provides full derivations of the structural results in Section 3. All proofs follow a clear step-by-step format.

A.1 Proof of Statement 3.1

Step 1: Expand the KFE. From (3.0.4),

$$\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial t} = g^2\varphi_{xx} + \big(2(g^2)_x + f\big)\varphi_x + \big((g^2)_{xx} + f_x\big)\varphi. \tag{A.1.1}$$

Equivalently, since $(g^2)_x = 2gg_x$,

$$\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial t} = g^2\varphi_{xx} + (4gg_x + f)\varphi_x + \big((g^2)_{xx} + f_x\big)\varphi.$$

Step 2: Apply rolling–maturity invariance (Axiom 2). Axiom 2 implies that the coefficients depend on calendar time only through remaining maturity $\tau = T - t$. Hence there exist functions F and G such that

$$f(x,t,T) = F(x,\tau), \qquad g(x,t,T) = G(x,\tau), \qquad \tau = T - t. \tag{A.1.2}$$

Step 3: Impose the affine-closure hypothesis. Assume that for each fixed τ,

$$\partial_{xx} G(x,\tau) = 0, \tag{A.1.3}$$

and that the net probability flux is affine in x:

$$\partial_x\big(G(x,\tau)^2\big) + F(x,\tau) = A(\tau)x + B(\tau) \tag{A.1.4}$$

for some functions $A(\tau)$ and $B(\tau)$.

Step 4: Solve for the diffusion. Equation (A.1.3) implies that G is affine in x. Therefore there exist functions $a(\tau)$ and $b(\tau)$ such that

$$G(x,\tau) = a(\tau)x + b(\tau). \tag{A.1.5}$$

Step 5: Solve for the drift. Substituting (A.1.5) into (A.1.4) gives

$$F(x,\tau) = A(\tau)x + B(\tau) - \partial_x\big(G(x,\tau)^2\big).$$

But

$$\partial_x\big(G(x,\tau)^2\big) = 2a(\tau)\big(a(\tau)x + b(\tau)\big),$$

which is affine in x. Hence F is affine in x as well, so there exist functions $a_1(\tau)$ and $b_1(\tau)$ such that

$$F(x,\tau) = a_1(\tau)x + b_1(\tau). \tag{A.1.6}$$

Step 6: Return to the original notation. Using $\tau = T - t$, equations (A.1.5) and (A.1.6) become

$$g(x,t,T) = a(T-t)x + b(T-t), \qquad f(x,t,T) = a_1(T-t)x + b_1(T-t).$$

Thus both diffusion and drift are affine in the IRFR state x, which establishes Statement 3.1.

A.2 Proof of Statement 3.2

Goal. Derive the equilibrium drift–diffusion relations (3.2.1a)–(3.2.1b).

Step 1: Equilibrium identity. Under Axiom 3, the equilibrium IRFR depends only on time-to-maturity, so that

$$x_{e,T-t} = x_{e,\tau}, \qquad \tau := T - t.$$

Hence

$$\frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial t} = -\,x'_{e,\tau}. \tag{A.2.12}$$

Step 2: First-moment evolution. From the Fokker–Planck equation, multiplying by x, integrating over $x \in [x_{\min}, \infty)$, and assuming the boundary terms vanish, gives

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = -\mathbb{E}[f(x,t,T)]. \tag{A.2.13}$$

Using the affine drift form from Statement 3.1,

$$f(x,t,T) = a_1(\tau)x + b_1(\tau), \tag{A.2.14}$$

it follows that

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = -\,a_1(\tau)\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] - b_1(\tau). \tag{A.2.15}$$

Step 3: Impose equilibrium. At equilibrium,

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = x_{e,\tau},$$

so (A.2.15) becomes

$$\frac{\partial x_{e,\tau}}{\partial t} = -\,a_1(\tau)x_{e,\tau} - b_1(\tau). \tag{A.2.16}$$

Using $\partial_t x_{e,\tau} = -x'_{e,\tau}$, we obtain

$$-\,x'_{e,\tau} = -\,a_1(\tau)x_{e,\tau} - b_1(\tau),$$

hence

$$b_1(\tau) = -\,a_1(\tau)x_{e,\tau} + x'_{e,\tau}. \tag{A.2.17}$$

Step 4: Drift relation. Substituting (A.2.17) into (A.2.14) yields

$$f(x,t,T) = a_1(\tau)x - a_1(\tau)x_{e,\tau} + x'_{e,\tau},$$

that is,

$$f(x,t,T) = a_1(\tau)\big(x - x_{e,\tau}\big) + x'_{e,\tau}. \tag{A.2.18}$$

Identifying x with the state variable $x_{t,T}$ gives (3.2.1a).

Step 5: Diffusion relation. Using the affine diffusion form from Statement 3.1,

$$g(x,t,T) = a(\tau)x + b(\tau), \tag{A.2.19}$$

together with the proportionality hypothesis

$$b(\tau) = \frac{a(\tau)}{a_1(\tau)}\,b_1(\tau), \tag{A.2.20}$$

and substituting (A.2.17), one finds

$$b(\tau) = \frac{a(\tau)}{a_1(\tau)}\Big(-\,a_1(\tau)x_{e,\tau} + x'_{e,\tau}\Big) = -\,a(\tau)x_{e,\tau} + \frac{a(\tau)}{a_1(\tau)}x'_{e,\tau}. \tag{A.2.21}$$

Therefore

$$g(x,t,T) = a(\tau)x - a(\tau)x_{e,\tau} + \frac{a(\tau)}{a_1(\tau)}x'_{e,\tau},$$

i.e.

$$g(x,t,T) = a(\tau)\big(x - x_{e,\tau}\big) + \frac{a(\tau)}{a_1(\tau)}x'_{e,\tau}. \tag{A.2.22}$$

Identifying x with the state variable $x_{t,T}$ gives (3.2.1b).

This proves Statement 3.2.

A.3 Proof of Statement 3.3

Goal. Show that, for fixed maturity T,

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = x_{e,T-t} + (x_{t_0,T} - x_{e,T-t_0})\, e^{-a_1(t-t_0)}.$$

Step 1: Start from the expectation dynamics. By Statement 3.3, the expected forward rate satisfies

$$\frac{\partial \mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}]}{\partial t} = -a_1\big(\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] - x_{e,T-t}\big) + \frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial t},$$

where $a_1 > 0$ is constant.

Step 2: Define the deviation from equilibrium. Let

$$z(t) := \mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] - x_{e,T-t}.$$

Then

$$\frac{dz(t)}{dt} = \frac{\partial \mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}]}{\partial t} - \frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial t}.$$

Substituting the expectation dynamics gives

$$\frac{dz(t)}{dt} = -a_1\big(\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] - x_{e,T-t}\big) = -a_1 z(t).$$

Step 3: Solve the differential equation. The solution is

$$z(t) = z(t_0)e^{-a_1(t-t_0)}.$$

Hence

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] - x_{e,T-t} = (\mathbb{E}[x_{t_0,T}] - x_{e,T-t_0})\, e^{-a_1(t-t_0)}.$$

Step 4: Apply the initial condition. At time t_0, the forward rate is known, so

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t_0,T}] = x_{t_0,T}.$$

Therefore

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] - x_{e,T-t} = (x_{t_0,T} - x_{e,T-t_0})\, e^{-a_1(t-t_0)}.$$

Rearranging yields

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = x_{e,T-t} + (x_{t_0,T} - x_{e,T-t_0})\, e^{-a_1(t-t_0)}. \tag{A.3.1}$$

This proves Statement 3.3.

A.4 Proof of Statement 3.4

Goal. Show that equilibrium transport consistency requires

$$a_1 = a^2.$$

Step 1: Start from the variance dynamics. Let

$$V(t,T) := \mathrm{Var}(x_{t,T}).$$

From the affine diffusion specification, the forward rate satisfies

$$dx_{t,T} = \big(-a_1 x_{t,T} + a_1 x_{e,T-t} + \partial_t x_{e,T-t}\big)\,dt + \big(a x_{t,T} + b(T-t)\big)\,dW_t,$$

where, by Statement 3.2,

$$b(T-t) = -a\,x_{e,T-t} + \frac{1}{a}x'_{e,T-t}.$$

Step 2: Derive the second-moment equation. Applying Itô's formula to $x_{t,T}^2$ and taking expectations gives

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}^2] &= 2\,\mathbb{E}\big[x_{t,T}\big(-a_1 x_{t,T} + a_1 x_{e,T-t} + \partial_t x_{e,T-t}\big)\big] + \mathbb{E}\Big[\big(a x_{t,T} + b(T-t)\big)^2\Big] \\ &= (-2a_1 + a^2)\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}^2] + \big(2a_1 x_{e,T-t} + 2\partial_t x_{e,T-t} + 2ab(T-t)\big)\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] + b(T-t)^2.\end{aligned} \tag{A.4.1}$$

Step 3: Pass from the second moment to the variance. Since

$$V(t,T) = \mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}^2] - \mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}]^2,$$

differentiate with respect to t:

$$\frac{\partial V}{\partial t} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}^2] - 2\,\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}]\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}].$$

Using Statement 3.3,

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = -a_1\big(\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] - x_{e,T-t}\big) + \partial_t x_{e,T-t}, \tag{A.4.2}$$

and substituting (A.4.1) and (A.4.2), the mixed terms cancel. This yields

$$\frac{\partial V}{\partial t} = 2(a^2 - a_1)V + \big(a\,x_{e,T-t} + b(T-t)\big)^2. \tag{A.4.3}$$

Step 4: Use the equilibrium diffusion relation. From Statement 3.2,

$$b(T-t) = -a\,x_{e,T-t} + \frac{1}{a}x'_{e,T-t}.$$

Hence

$$a\, x_{e,T-t} + b(T-t) = \frac{1}{a} x'_{e,T-t},$$

so (A.4.3) becomes

$$\frac{\partial V}{\partial t} = 2(a^2 - a_1)V + \frac{1}{a^2}\big(x'_{e,T-t}\big)^2. \tag{A.4.4}$$

Step 5: Impose equilibrium transport consistency. Under equilibrium transport, admissible term-structure objects depend on calendar time and maturity only through

$$\tau := T - t.$$

In particular, the variance must satisfy

$$V(t,T) = \widetilde{V}(\tau)$$

for some function $\widetilde{V}$. Therefore

$$\frac{\partial V}{\partial t} = -\widetilde{V}'(\tau),$$

and (A.4.4) becomes

$$-\widetilde{V}'(\tau) = 2(a^2 - a_1)\widetilde{V}(\tau) + \frac{1}{a^2}\big(x'_e(\tau)\big)^2. \tag{A.4.5}$$

Now suppose $a_1 \neq a^2$. Then the coefficient on $\widetilde{V}(\tau)$ in (A.4.5) is nonzero, so the variance dynamics contain an additional exponential decay or growth term that is independent of the equilibrium transport speed a. This breaks the required one-parameter transport structure: the evolution of the variance would no longer be governed solely by the same decay scale that determines the equilibrium forward-curve propagation.

Therefore the transport-consistent equilibrium representation is possible only if

$$2(a^2 - a_1) = 0.$$

Hence

$$a_1 = a^2. \tag{A.4.6}$$

This proves Statement 3.4.

A.5 Proof of Statement 3.5

Goal. Show that once the baseline exponential equilibrium specification is imposed, consistency of the equilibrium relations determines the interim forms (3.5.1a)–(3.5.1b).

Step 1: Start from the equilibrium drift and diffusion relations.

From Appendix A.2, the equilibrium relations are

$$f(x,t,T) = a_1 x_{t,T} - a_1 x_{e,T-t} - \frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial t}, \tag{A.5.1a}$$

$$g(x,t,T) = a x_{t,T} - a x_{e,T-t} - \frac{a}{a_1}\frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial t}. \tag{A.5.1b}$$

Since $\tau = T - t$, we have

$$-\frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial t} = \frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial T}.$$

Using Statement 3.4, namely $a_1 = a^2$, this becomes

$$f(x,t,T) = a^2 x_{t,T} - a^2 x_{e,T-t} + \frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial T}, \tag{A.5.2a}$$

$$g(x,t,T) = a x_{t,T} - a x_{e,T-t} + \frac{1}{a}\frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial T}. \tag{A.5.2b}$$

Step 2: Impose the baseline exponential equilibrium specification.

At this stage, no unique functional form for $x_{e,T-t}$ has been derived. We now impose the baseline exponential equilibrium specification used in the main text:

$$x_{e,T-t} = x_\infty + Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}. \tag{A.5.3}$$

Equivalently, in the maturity variable $\tau = T - t$,

$$x_{e,\tau} = x_\infty + Ae^{-\lambda^2\tau}. \tag{A.5.4}$$

Differentiating (A.5.3) with respect to T yields

$$\frac{\partial x_{e,T-t}}{\partial T} = -\lambda^2 Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}. \tag{A.5.5}$$

Step 3: Substitute into the equilibrium relations.

Substituting (A.5.3) and (A.5.5) into (A.5.2a) gives

$$\begin{aligned} f(x,t,T) &= a^2 x_{t,T} - a^2\Big(x_\infty + Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}\Big) - \lambda^2 Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)} \\ &= a^2 x_{t,T} - a^2 x_\infty - (\lambda^2 + a^2)Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}. \end{aligned} \tag{A.5.6}$$

Likewise, substituting (A.5.3) and (A.5.5) into (A.5.2b) gives

$$\begin{aligned} g(x,t,T) &= a x_{t,T} - a\Big(x_\infty + Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}\Big) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a}Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)} \\ &= a x_{t,T} - a x_\infty - \left(a + \frac{\lambda^2}{a}\right)Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}. \end{aligned} \tag{A.5.7}$$

Conclusion.

Thus, once the baseline exponential equilibrium curve is imposed, consistency of the equilibrium drift and diffusion relations yields the interim forms (3.5.1a)–(3.5.1b). This is a conditional identification result, not a uniqueness statement about all admissible equilibrium curves.

A.6 Proof of Statement 3.6

Goal. Derive the variance evolution implied by the interim drift and diffusion forms obtained under the baseline exponential equilibrium specification.

Step 1: Start from the interim diffusion form.

From Appendix A.5, once the baseline exponential equilibrium curve is imposed, the diffusion coefficient is

$$g(x,t,T) = ax_{t,T} - ax_\infty - \left(a + \frac{\lambda^2}{a}\right) Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}. \tag{A.6.1}$$

Step 2: Decompose the state into mean plus fluctuation.

Let

$$m(t,T) := \mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}].$$

Under the same baseline specification, the mean forward curve has the representation

$$m(t,T) = x_\infty + Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)} + D(t,T), \tag{A.6.2}$$

where

$$D(t,T) = \left(x_{t_0,T} - x_\infty - Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t_0)}\right) e^{-a^2(t-t_0)}. \tag{A.6.3}$$

Now define the centred fluctuation

$$\widetilde{x}_{t,T} := x_{t,T} - m(t,T), \qquad \mathbb{E}[\widetilde{x}_{t,T}] = 0.$$

Substituting $x_{t,T} = m(t,T) + \widetilde{x}_{t,T}$ together with (A.6.2) into (A.6.1) gives

$$\begin{aligned} g(x,t,T) &= a\big(m(t,T) + \widetilde{x}_{t,T}\big) - ax_\infty - \left(a + \frac{\lambda^2}{a}\right) Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)} \\ &= a\widetilde{x}_{t,T} + aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a} Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}. \end{aligned} \tag{A.6.4}$$

Step 3: Apply the second-moment identity.

The second moment satisfies

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}^2] = -2\,\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T} f(x,t,T)] + 2\,\mathbb{E}[g(x,t,T)^2]. \tag{A.6.5}$$

Using

$$\mathrm{Var}(x_{t,T}) = \mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}^2] - m(t,T)^2,$$

we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathrm{Var}(x_{t,T}) &= \frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}^2] - \frac{\partial}{\partial t} m(t,T)^2 \\ &= -2\Big(\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T} f(x,t,T)] - m(t,T)\mathbb{E}[f(x,t,T)]\Big) + 2\,\mathbb{E}[g(x,t,T)^2]. \end{aligned} \tag{A.6.6}$$

From Appendix A.5, the drift is affine:

$$f(x,t,T) = a^2 x_{t,T} - a^2 x_\infty - (\lambda^2 + a^2) A e^{-\lambda^2 (T-t)}.$$

Therefore its covariance with $x_{t,T}$ is simply

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T} f(x,t,T)] - m(t,T)\mathbb{E}[f(x,t,T)] = a^2 \operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T}),$$

and (A.6.6) becomes

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T}) = -2a^2 \operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T}) + 2\,\mathbb{E}[g(x,t,T)^2]. \tag{A.6.7}$$

Step 4: Evaluate the diffusion-square expectation.

From (A.6.4), write

$$g(x,t,T) = a\widetilde{x}_{t,T} + b(t,T), \qquad b(t,T) := aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a} A e^{-\lambda^2 (T-t)}.$$

Hence

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{E}[g(x,t,T)^2] &= \mathbb{E}\big[(a\widetilde{x}_{t,T} + b(t,T))^2\big] \\
&= a^2 \mathbb{E}[\widetilde{x}_{t,T}^2] + 2ab(t,T)\mathbb{E}[\widetilde{x}_{t,T}] + b(t,T)^2 \\
&= a^2 \operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T}) + \left(aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a} A e^{-\lambda^2 (T-t)} \right)^2,
\end{aligned} \tag{A.6.8}$$

because $\mathbb{E}[\widetilde{x}_{t,T}] = 0$.

Substituting (A.6.8) into (A.6.7) yields

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T}) &= -2a^2 \operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T}) + 2a^2 \operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T}) \\
&\quad + 2 \left(aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a} A e^{-\lambda^2 (T-t)} \right)^2 \\
&= 2 \left(aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a} A e^{-\lambda^2 (T-t)} \right)^2.
\end{aligned} \tag{A.6.9}$$

Conclusion.

Thus, under the baseline exponential equilibrium specification, the variance evolution implied by the interim affine forms is exactly

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T}) = 2 \left(aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a} A e^{-\lambda^2 (T-t)} \right)^2,$$

which proves Statement 3.6.

A.7 Proof of Statement 3.7

Goal. Derive the market signal-to-noise ratio.

Step 1: Start from the variance rate.

From Appendix A.6, the instantaneous variance rate is

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T}) = 2\left(aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a}Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}\right)^2. \tag{A.7.1}$$

Hence the instantaneous noise scale is

$$\sqrt{\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T})} = \sqrt{2}\left|aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a}Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}\right|. \tag{A.7.2}$$

Step 2: Evaluate the drift on the mean branch.

From Appendix A.5, the interim drift is

$$f(x,t,T) = a^2x_{t,T} - a^2x_\infty - (\lambda^2 + a^2)Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}. \tag{A.7.3}$$

Let

$$m(t,T) := \mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = x_\infty + Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)} + D(t,T),$$

as obtained in Statement 3.6. Evaluating the drift along this mean branch gives

$$\begin{aligned} f\big(m(t,T),t,T\big) &= a^2\Big(x_\infty + Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)} + D(t,T)\Big) - a^2x_\infty - (\lambda^2+a^2)Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)} \\ &= a^2D(t,T) - \lambda^2Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)} \\ &= a\left(aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a}Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}\right). \end{aligned} \tag{A.7.4}$$

Therefore the instantaneous signal scale, defined by the magnitude of the drift along the mean branch, is

$$\big|f\big(m(t,T),t,T\big)\big| = a\left|aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a}Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}\right|. \tag{A.7.5}$$

Step 3: Form the ratio.

Hence

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{MSNR} &= \frac{\big|f\big(m(t,T),t,T\big)\big|}{\sqrt{\partial_t \operatorname{Var}(x_{t,T})}} \\ &= \frac{a\left|aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a}Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}\right|}{\sqrt{2}\left|aD(t,T) - \frac{\lambda^2}{a}Ae^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}\right|} \\ &= \frac{a}{\sqrt{2}}. \end{aligned} \tag{A.7.6}$$

Conclusion.

Therefore,

$$\mathrm{MSNR} = \frac{a}{\sqrt{2}},$$

which proves Statement 3.7.

Appendix B Solution to the KFE in the equilibrium regime

B.1 Full Frobenius Proof of the equilibrium regime PDF

We begin from the transformed KFE in the shifted variable

$$\widetilde{x} = x_{t,T} - x_\infty\Big(1 - e^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}\Big),$$

so that the equilibrium mean has been removed, but without yet imposing any relation between λ and a. In these coordinates the KFE takes the form

$$\frac{\partial\varphi}{\partial t} = a^2\widetilde{x}^2\varphi_{\widetilde{x}\widetilde{x}} + 5a^2\widetilde{x}\,\varphi_{\widetilde{x}} + 3a^2\varphi - \lambda^2 x_\infty e^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}\varphi_{\widetilde{x}}. \tag{B.1.1}$$

To analyse the singular structure at $\widetilde{x} = 0$, introduce the reciprocal variable

$$z = \frac{1}{\widetilde{x}}, \qquad z_{\widetilde{x}} = -z^2, \qquad z_{\widetilde{x}\widetilde{x}} = 2z^3.$$

Using

$$\varphi_{\widetilde{x}} = -z^2\varphi_z, \qquad \varphi_{\widetilde{x}\widetilde{x}} = z^4\varphi_{zz} + 2z^3\varphi_z,$$

equation (B.1.1) becomes

$$\frac{\partial\varphi}{\partial t} = a^2z^2\varphi_{zz} - 3a^2z\varphi_z + 3a^2\varphi + \lambda^2 x_\infty e^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}z^2\varphi_z. \tag{B.1.2}$$

Step 1: Frobenius expansion.

Seek a Frobenius series of the form

$$\varphi(z,t,T) = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} c_i(t)\, z^{i+m}.$$

Then

$$\varphi_z = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty}(i+m)c_i(t)\, z^{i+m-1}, \qquad \varphi_{zz} = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty}(i+m)(i+m-1)c_i(t)\, z^{i+m-2}.$$

Substituting into (B.1.2) and matching coefficients of z^{i+m} yields

$$\frac{\partial c_i}{\partial t} = a^2(i+m-1)(i+m-3)c_i + \lambda^2 x_\infty e^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}(i+m-1)c_{i-1}, \tag{B.1.3}$$

with $c_{-1} \equiv 0$.

Step 2: Separate the time dependence.

Write

$$c_i(t) = c_i^*\, x_\infty^{i+n} e^{-(i+n)\lambda^2(T-t)}.$$

Then

$$\frac{\partial c_i}{\partial t} = (i+n)\lambda^2 c_i(t).$$

Substituting into (B.1.3) and cancelling the common factor $x_\infty^{i+n} e^{-(i+n)\lambda^2(T-t)}$ gives

$$(i+n)\lambda^2 c_i^* = a^2(i+m-1)(i+m-3)c_i^* + \lambda^2(i+m-1)c_{i-1}^*.$$

At $i=0$, since $c_{-1}^*=0$, this reduces to the indicial relation

$$n\,\frac{\lambda^2}{a^2} = (m-1)(m-3). \tag{B.1.4}$$

For $i \geq 1$, subtracting (B.1.4) gives

$$\lambda^2 i\, c_i^* = a^2 i(i+2m-4)c_i^* + \lambda^2(i+m-1)c_{i-1}^*,$$

hence

$$\frac{c_i^*}{c_{i-1}^*} = -\frac{\frac{\lambda^2}{a^2}(i+m-1)}{i\left(i+2m-4-\frac{\lambda^2}{a^2}\right)}. \tag{B.1.5}$$

Step 3: Characterise the non-terminating admissible branch.

Let

$$r := \frac{\lambda^2}{a^2}.$$

For the Frobenius series to sum to a single inverse-gamma-type branch, the coefficient ratio needs to have the form

$$\frac{c_i^*}{c_{i-1}^*} = -\frac{\beta}{i}$$

for some constant $\beta > 0$; equivalently, the additional affine factor in (B.1.5) needs to reduce to an i-independent constant. Since the numerator and denominator in (B.1.5) are both affine in i with the same slope, this occurs if and only if they are identical, namely

$$i+m-1 = i+2m-4-r.$$

Therefore

$$m = 3+r. \tag{B.1.6}$$

Substituting (B.1.6) into (B.1.5) gives

$$\frac{c_i^*}{c_{i-1}^*} = -\frac{r}{i}, \qquad c_i^* = \frac{(-r)^i}{i!}\,c_0^*. \tag{B.1.7}$$

The indicial relation (B.1.4) then yields

$$n = r+2. \tag{B.1.8}$$

Hence the admissible branch is the one-parameter family

$$\varphi(z,t,T) = c_0^* x_\infty^{r+2} z^{r+3} e^{-(r+2)\lambda^2(T-t)} \exp\left[-r x_\infty e^{-\lambda^2(T-t)} z\right].$$

Returning to $\widetilde{x} = 1/z$, this becomes

$$\varphi(\widetilde{x},t,T) = c_0^* x_\infty^{r+2} e^{-(r+2)\lambda^2(T-t)} \widetilde{x}^{-(r+3)} \exp\left(-\frac{r x_\infty e^{-\lambda^2(T-t)}}{\widetilde{x}}\right). \tag{B.1.9}$$

Thus the Frobenius construction yields an inverse-gamma family with shape parameter

$$\alpha = r + 2.$$

Step 4: Select the structural branch.

The branch retained in the manuscript is the order-3 shifted inverse-gamma law, equivalently the branch with tail $\widetilde{x}^{-4}$ and finite second moment. Since (B.1.9) has tail exponent $-(r+3)$, this requires

$$r + 3 = 4, \qquad \text{so that} \qquad r = 1.$$

Therefore

$$\boxed{\lambda^2 = a^2}. \tag{B.1.10}$$

From (B.1.6) and (B.1.8) we then obtain

$$m = 4, \qquad n = 3.$$

The recurrence (B.1.7) reduces to

$$\frac{c_i^*}{c_{i-1}^*} = -\frac{1}{i}, \qquad c_i^* = \frac{(-1)^i}{i!}\, c_0^*,$$

so the Frobenius series sums to

$$\varphi(z, t, T) = c_0^* x_\infty^3 z^4 e^{-3a^2(T-t)} \exp\!\big[-x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)} z\big].$$

Returning to $\widetilde{x} = 1/z$ gives

$$\varphi(\widetilde{x}, t, T) = c_0^* \frac{x_\infty^3 e^{-3a^2(T-t)}}{\widetilde{x}^4} \exp\!\left(-\frac{x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)}}{\widetilde{x}}\right). \tag{B.1.11}$$

Normalisation fixes $c_0^* = 1/\Gamma(3)$, and therefore

$$\boxed{\varphi(\widetilde{x}, t, T) = \frac{x_\infty^3 e^{-3a^2(T-t)}}{\Gamma(3)\,\widetilde{x}^4} \exp\!\left(-\frac{x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)}}{\widetilde{x}}\right)} \tag{B.1.12}$$

which is the shifted inverse-gamma distribution of order 3.

B.2 Direct Laplace-Transform Derivation of the MGF

Let

$$\beta_{t,T} = x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)}.$$

From (B.1.12), the shifted variable $\widetilde{x}$ has density

$$\varphi(\widetilde{x}, t, T) = \frac{\beta_{t,T}^3}{\Gamma(3)\,\widetilde{x}^4} \exp\!\left(-\frac{\beta_{t,T}}{\widetilde{x}}\right), \qquad \widetilde{x} > 0.$$

We therefore compute its Laplace transform directly. For $q > 0$, define

$$\widehat{\varphi}(q,t,T) = \int_0^\infty e^{-q\widetilde{x}} \varphi(\widetilde{x},t,T)\, d\widetilde{x}.$$

Substituting the density gives

$$\widehat{\varphi}(q,t,T) = \frac{\beta_{t,T}^3}{\Gamma(3)} \int_0^\infty \widetilde{x}^{-4} \exp\left(-q\widetilde{x} - \frac{\beta_{t,T}}{\widetilde{x}}\right) d\widetilde{x}. \tag{B.2.1}$$

Using the standard integral identity

$$\int_0^\infty x^{\nu-1} \exp(-\mu x - \eta/x)\, dx = 2\left(\frac{\eta}{\mu}\right)^{\nu/2} K_\nu(2\sqrt{\mu\eta})\,,$$

with $\nu = -3$, $\mu = q$, and $\eta = \beta_{t,T}$, and using $K_{-\nu} = K_\nu$, we obtain

$$\widehat{\varphi}(q,t,T) = \frac{2\beta_{t,T}^3}{\Gamma(3)} \left(\frac{q}{\beta_{t,T}}\right)^{3/2} K_3\left(2\sqrt{\beta_{t,T} q}\right). \tag{B.2.2}$$

Since $\Gamma(3) = 2$, this simplifies to

$$\widehat{\varphi}(q,t,T) = (\beta_{t,T} q)^{3/2} K_3\left(2\sqrt{\beta_{t,T} q}\right) = \left(x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)} q\right)^{3/2} K_3\left(2\sqrt{x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)} q}\right). \tag{B.2.3}$$

If one prefers the moment-generating-function variable s, write $q = -s$. Then the transform is well defined for $s < 0$ and becomes

$$\widetilde{\varphi}(s,t,T) = \left(-x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)} s\right)^{3/2} K_3\left(2\sqrt{-x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t)} s}\right), \qquad s < 0. \tag{B.2.4}$$

This is exactly the Laplace transform, equivalently the MGF evaluated on its negative argument, of the inverse-gamma law of order 3.

B.3 Derivation of the Identified Expectation Formula

Goal. Show that, in the baseline identified case,

$$\mathbb{E}\left[x_{t,T}\right] = x_{t_0,t_0} e^{-a^2(T+t-2t_0)} + x_\infty - x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t_0)}. \tag{B.3.1}$$

Step 1: Start from equation (2.3.7)**.** We have

$$\frac{\partial \mathbb{E}\left[x_{t,T}\right]}{\partial t} = -a^2 \left[\left(x_{t_0,t_0} - \frac{x_\infty}{2}\right) e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} - \frac{x_\infty}{2} e^{a^2(t-t_0)}\right] e^{-a^2(T-t_0)}.$$

Step 2: Integrate with respect to time. Integrating from t_0 to t gives

$$\int_{t_0}^t \frac{\partial \mathbb{E}\left[x_{s,T}\right]}{\partial s}\, ds = -a^2 e^{-a^2(T-t_0)} \int_{t_0}^t \left[\left(x_{t_0,t_0} - \frac{x_\infty}{2}\right) e^{-a^2(s-t_0)} - \frac{x_\infty}{2} e^{a^2(s-t_0)}\right] ds.$$

Hence

$$\mathbb{E}\left[x_{t,T}\right] - x_{t_0,T} = -a^2 e^{-a^2(T-t_0)} \int_{t_0}^{t} \left[\left(x_{t_0,t_0} - \frac{x_\infty}{2}\right) e^{-a^2(s-t_0)} - \frac{x_\infty}{2} e^{a^2(s-t_0)}\right] ds.$$

Step 3: Evaluate the integral. Computing the integrals yields

$$\mathbb{E}\left[x_{t,T}\right] - x_{t_0,T} = e^{-a^2(T-t_0)} \left[\left(x_{t_0,t_0} - \frac{x_\infty}{2}\right)\left(e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} - 1\right) + \frac{x_\infty}{2}\left(e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} - 1\right)\right].$$

Collecting terms,

$$\mathbb{E}\left[x_{t,T}\right] - x_{t_0,T} = x_{t_0,t_0} e^{-a^2(T-t_0)} \left(e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} - 1\right).$$

Therefore,

$$\mathbb{E}\left[x_{t,T}\right] = x_{t_0,T} + x_{t_0,t_0} e^{-a^2(T-t_0)} \left(e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} - 1\right).$$

Step 4: Substitute for $x_{t_0,T}$. Using

$$x_{t_0,T} = (x_{t_0,t_0} - x_\infty) e^{-a^2(T-t_0)} + x_\infty,$$

we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{E}\left[x_{t,T}\right] &= (x_{t_0,t_0} - x_\infty) e^{-a^2(T-t_0)} + x_\infty + x_{t_0,t_0} e^{-a^2(T-t_0)} \left(e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} - 1\right) \\
&= x_\infty - x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t_0)} + x_{t_0,t_0} e^{-a^2(T-t_0)} e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} \\
&= x_{t_0,t_0} e^{-a^2(T+t-2t_0)} + x_\infty - x_\infty e^{-a^2(T-t_0)}.
\end{aligned}$$

which is exactly (B.3.1).

Appendix C Relation to Conventional Interest Rates

This appendix maps the instantaneous rolling forward rate (IRFR) to the conventional rate $r_{t,T}$ with remaining maturity $T - t$. Although the conventional rate fixes the maturity date T, the IRFRs appearing in its definition continue to "roll" with time. We provide both discrete-time and continuous-time expressions and derive several key results used in Section 6.

C.1 Expected Value and Instantaneous Variance of the Conventional Rate

In this section, key calculations and representations are mapped from the IRFR onto the conventional interest rate $r_{t,T}$ at time t with maturity $T - t$. The reader should note that the forward rates appearing in this representation remain rolling in maturity.

The IRFR relates to the conventional rate as

$$r_{t,T} = \frac{1}{T-t} \sum_{S=t}^{T} x_{t,S}$$

in discrete time, and

$$r_{t,T} = \frac{1}{T-t}\int_t^T x_{t,S}\,dS. \tag{C.1.1}$$

Expected value.

To compute the expected value of $r_{t,T}$, we begin from

$$\mathbb{E}[x_{t,T}] = x_{t_0,t_0}e^{-a^2(T+t-2t_0)} + x_\infty\left(1 - e^{-a^2(T-t_0)}\right). \tag{C.1.2}$$

Integrating over maturities,

$$\mathbb{E}\left[\int_t^T x_{t,S}\,dS\right] = \int_t^T \left(x_{t_0,t_0}e^{-a^2(S+t-2t_0)} + x_\infty\left(1 - e^{-a^2(S-t_0)}\right)\right)dS.$$

Evaluating term by term,

$$\int_t^T x_{t_0,t_0}e^{-a^2(S+t-2t_0)}\,dS = \frac{x_{t_0,t_0}}{a^2}\left(e^{-2a^2(t-t_0)} - e^{-a^2(T+t-2t_0)}\right),$$

$$\int_t^T x_\infty\,dS = x_\infty(T-t),$$

$$\int_t^T x_\infty e^{-a^2(S-t_0)}\,dS = \frac{x_\infty}{a^2}\left(e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} - e^{-a^2(T-t_0)}\right).$$

Hence,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}\left[\int_t^T x_{t,S}\,dS\right] &= \frac{x_{t_0,t_0}}{a^2}\left(e^{-2a^2(t-t_0)} - e^{-a^2(T+t-2t_0)}\right)\\ &\quad + x_\infty(T-t) - \frac{x_\infty}{a^2}\left(e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} - e^{-a^2(T-t_0)}\right).\end{aligned} \tag{C.1.3}$$

Using (C.1.1), we obtain

$$\mathbb{E}[r_{t,T}] = x_\infty + \frac{1}{a^2(T-t)}\left[x_{t_0,t_0}\left(e^{-2a^2(t-t_0)} - e^{-a^2(T+t-2t_0)}\right) - x_\infty\left(e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} - e^{-a^2(T-t_0)}\right)\right]. \tag{C.1.4}$$

Instantaneous variance.

To compute the instantaneous variance, consider two maturities T_1 and T_2, and define

$$x_{t,T_1} = (x_{t,t} - x_\infty)e^{-a^2(T_1-t)} + x_\infty, \qquad y_{t,T_2} = (x_{t,t} - x_\infty)e^{-a^2(T_2-t)} + x_\infty.$$

Then

$$y_{t,T_2} - x_\infty = (x_{t,T_1} - x_\infty)e^{-a^2(T_2-T_1)}.$$

Differentiating,

$$\frac{\partial y_{t,T_2}}{\partial x_{t,T_1}} = e^{-a^2(T_2-T_1)}.$$

Using covariance identities,

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathrm{Cov}(x_{t,T_1}, y_{t,T_2}) = e^{-a^2(T_2-T_1)}\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathrm{Var}(x_{t,T_1}).$$

Using the variance identity,

$$\mathrm{Var}(x+y) = \mathrm{Var}(x) + \mathrm{Var}(y) + 2\mathrm{Cov}(x,y),$$

we obtain

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathrm{Var}(x_{t,T_1} + y_{t,T_2}) = \frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathrm{Var}(x_{t,T_1})\left(1 + e^{-a^2(T_2-T_1)}\right)^2.$$

From the IRFR variance result,

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathrm{Var}(x_{t,T_1}) = 2a^2\left(\left(x_{t_0,t_0} - \frac{x_\infty}{2}\right)e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} + \frac{x_\infty}{2}e^{a^2(t-t_0)}\right)^2 e^{-2a^2(T_1-t_0)}.$$

Hence, for the continuous case,

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathrm{Var}\left(\int_t^T x_{t,S}\,dS\right) = 2a^2\left(\left(x_{t_0,t_0} - \frac{x_\infty}{2}\right)e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} + \frac{x_\infty}{2}e^{a^2(t-t_0)}\right)^2 \times \left(\int_t^T e^{-a^2(S-t_0)}\,dS\right)^2. \tag{C.1.5}$$

Using (C.1.1), we obtain

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathrm{Var}(r_{t,T}) = \frac{2}{a^2(T-t)^2}\left(\left(x_{t_0,t_0} - \frac{x_\infty}{2}\right)e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} + \frac{x_\infty}{2}e^{a^2(t-t_0)}\right)^2\left(e^{-a^2(t-t_0)} - e^{-a^2(T-t_0)}\right)^2. \tag{C.1.6}$$

An alternative representation is

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\mathrm{Var}(r_{t,T}) = \frac{2}{a^2(T-t)^2}\left(\left(x_{t_0,t_0} - \frac{x_\infty}{2}\right)e^{-2a^2(t-t_0)} + \frac{x_\infty}{2}\right)^2\left(1 - e^{-a^2(T-t)}\right)^2. \tag{C.1.7}$$

Appendix D No-Arbitrage Justification of Rolling Maturity Invariance

D.1 Objective

This appendix provides a rigorous no-arbitrage justification for Axiom 2 (Rolling Maturity Invariance). We show that if the stochastic dynamics of the instantaneous rolling forward rate (IRFR) depend on calendar time rather than solely on remaining maturity, then a self-financing trading strategy exists that generates arbitrage.

D.2 IRFR as a Tradable P&L Object

Recall the bond pricing identity:

$$\int_t^T x_{t,S}\, dS = -\ln P(t,T).$$

Differentiating with respect to time implies that infinitesimal changes in the IRFR correspond to changes in zero-coupon bond prices. Therefore, there exists a self-financing portfolio of bonds whose instantaneous profit and loss satisfies:

$$dV_t = dx_{t,T}.$$

Thus, increments of the IRFR are directly associated with tradable P&L.

D.3 Two Equivalent Trading Strategies

Fix a maturity horizon $\tau > 0$. Consider two strategies initiated at time t:

Strategy A (Hold Strategy)

- Enter a forward exposure corresponding to $x_{t,T}$, where $T = t + \tau$
- Hold continuously over $[t, t + \Delta t]$

The P&L over the interval is:

$$\Delta V^{\text{hold}} = x_{t+\Delta t,T} - x_{t,T}.$$

Strategy B (Rolling Strategy)

- Enter the same exposure at time t
- At time $t + \Delta t$, close the position
- Re-enter a forward exposure with the same remaining maturity τ, i.e. $x_{t+\Delta t,T+\Delta t}$

The P&L over the same interval is:

$$\Delta V^{\text{roll}} = x_{t+\Delta t,T+\Delta t} - x_{t,T}.$$

D.4 No-Arbitrage Requirement

Both strategies represent exposure to a forward rate with identical remaining maturity τ. Therefore, no-arbitrage requires that they produce identical gains:

$$\Delta V^{\text{hold}} = \Delta V^{\text{roll}}.$$

Substituting expressions yields:

$$x_{t+\Delta t,T} = x_{t+\Delta t,T+\Delta t}.$$

Taking the limit as $\Delta t \to 0$, this implies:

$$dx_{t,T} = dx_{t+dt,T+dt}$$

in distribution.

D.5 Implication for Dynamics

The above identity shows that the stochastic evolution of the IRFR must be invariant along trajectories of constant remaining maturity:

$$\tau = T - t.$$

Therefore, the drift and diffusion coefficients must satisfy:

$$\mu(x, t, T) = \mu(x, \tau), \quad \sigma(x, t, T) = \sigma(x, \tau).$$

This establishes Axiom 2.

D.6 Arbitrage Construction Under Violation

Suppose instead that dynamics depend explicitly on calendar time, so that:

$$\mu(x, t, T) \neq \mu(x, t + \Delta t, T + \Delta t).$$

Then:

$$\mathbb{E}[\Delta V^{\text{hold}}] \neq \mathbb{E}[\Delta V^{\text{roll}}].$$

Construct a portfolio:

- Long Strategy B (rolling)
- Short Strategy A (hold)

This portfolio:

- has zero initial cost
- eliminates common risk exposure
- yields strictly positive expected return

Since both strategies are replicable via bond portfolios, this constitutes an arbitrage.

D.7 Interpretation

The result enforces a path-independence condition:

> The P&L from maintaining a forward exposure must be independent of whether the exposure is implemented continuously or via rolling.

Equivalently, the stochastic law governing the IRFR must be invariant under the transformation:

$$(t, T) \mapsto (t + \Delta t, T + \Delta t).$$

This invariance is precisely the content of Axiom 2.

D.8 Conclusion

We have shown that rolling–maturity invariance is not merely a modelling convenience but a necessary condition for the absence of dynamic arbitrage. Any dependence of IRFR dynamics on calendar time would permit the construction of self-financing trading strategies that generate arbitrage through rolling inconsistencies.

Thus, Axiom 2 is justified as a no-arbitrage condition.